English punctuation: practice set

16 original questions for 11 Plus skill preparation. Supports families preparing for tests taken in 2027; not an official paper, past paper or school-specific mock.

Scope: apostrophes and direct-speech punctuation. This set does not assess the full English syllabus.

Use untimed first. Work on paper, show your reasoning, and keep the separate answer booklet closed until you finish. No official test duration or predicted admissions score applies.

Find both booklets and online practice: https://www.11plusexampapers.com/papers

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Name: _____ Date: _____

Apostrophes

Passage for question 6:

Before the exhibition, one curator checked the artists’ labels. Two visitors left their umbrellas beside the children’s drawings. “It’s almost ready,” the curator said, lifting a model onto its stand. “We’ve only got the lights to test.”

Context: several artists and children are involved; there is one curator.

1. Rewrite “We have finished the display” using a contraction.

2. One gardener owns several spades. Rewrite “the spades belonging to the gardener”.

3. Four musicians share a rehearsal room. Rewrite “the room used by the musicians” using possession.

4. Rewrite “the helmets belonging to the children” using possession.

5. Complete: “The museum has changed ___ entrance, and ___ easier to find.”

6. In the exhibition passage, what two words does “It’s” replace?

7. Correct this sentence: “The baker sold six loaf’s before lunch.”

8. Explain the difference between “the dancer’s shoes” and “the dancers’ shoes”.

Source guide: https://www.11plusexampapers.com/blog/11-plus-apostrophes

Direct Speech Punctuation

9. Add punctuation: Leah said the lantern is in the cupboard

10. Correct: “The bridge is safe.” he said.

11. Add punctuation: where did you leave the map she asked

12. Correct: “Stop”! shouted Arun.

13. Punctuate as one interrupted spoken sentence: if we leave now said Mei we can catch the bus

14. Punctuate as two complete spoken sentences: the rain has stopped said Mei we can go outside

15. Correct: “I found it,” Priya lifted the notebook.

16. Punctuate and paragraph this exchange: are you ready asked Ben almost replied Imani

Source guide: https://www.11plusexampapers.com/blog/11-plus-direct-speech-punctuation